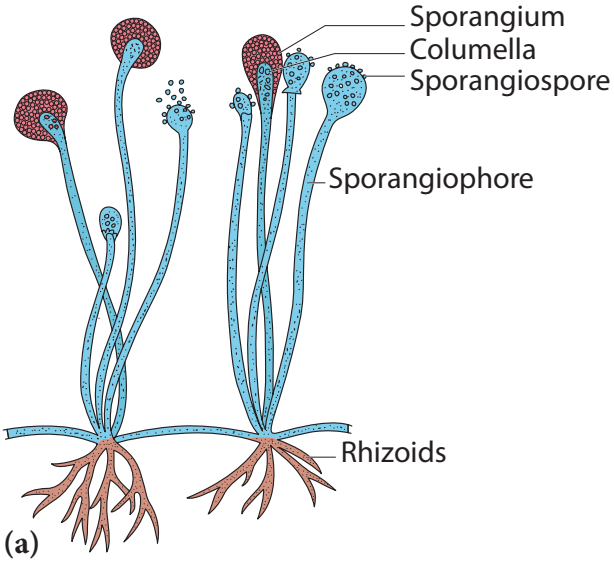
www.tntextbooks.in

Zygomycetes

- Most of the species are saprophytic and live on decaying plant and animal matter in the soil. Some lead parasitic life (Example: *Entomophthora* on housefly)
- Bread mold fungi (Example: *Mucor, Rhizopus*) and Coprophilous fungi (Fungi growing on dung Example: *Pilobolus*) belong to this group (Figure 1.21).



(a)



(b)

Figure 1.21: Zygomycetes (a) *Rhizopus* (b) *Pilobolus*

- The mycelium is branched and coenocytic.
- Asexual reproduction by means of spores produced in sporangia.
- Sexual reproduction is by the fusion of the gametangia which results in thick walled zygospore. It remains dormant for long periods. The zygospore undergoes meiosis and produce spores.

Ascomycetes

- Ascomycetes include a wide range of fungi such as yeasts, powdery mildews, cup fungi, morels and so on (Figure 1.22).



(a) *Morchella*



(b) *Peziza*



(c) Cleistothecium